

August 2026

Dear Raanan,

I've been selling homes in Orinda for a long time, and single-level properties with genuine hill views on a lot of this size don't come along very often. When 136 Ardith Dr. came on the market, the combination of that updated open floor plan, the 10-foot island kitchen, the hardwood floors, and those expansive windows framing the hillside caught my attention right away. So when the listing came off market after only 19 days without a sale, I wanted to reach out personally.

Nineteen days is short, and on the surface it might not look like a problem worth examining. But in Orinda's current market, a home with this much going for it, priced at \$959 per square foot, should have generated serious offers in that window, not questions. My read is that the listing description worked harder to list features than it did to tell the story of what this house actually feels like to live in, and that gap can cost a seller at any price point, but especially at this one.

I've put together a brief analysis of how I see the listing history, where I think the strategy fell short, and what a relaunch would need to look like to get this home in front of the right buyers at the right number. It's all in the pages that follow.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside. But if you haven't made that decision yet and want a second set of eyes, I'd genuinely welcome a conversation.

With respect,



Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

136 Ardith Dr.

Orinda, CA 94563

4.0 Beds · 3 Baths · 1,975 Sq Ft · Orinda

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 136 Ardith Dr.

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Single-Level View Home with a Rare Combination of Space and Setting - and a Listing That Didn't Show It

136 Ardith Dr. has the profile Orinda buyers are actively looking for: single-level living with a flexible open floor plan, a 10-foot kitchen island, wide plank hardwood floors, a flagstone fireplace hearth, and an 18,320 square foot lot positioned to capture long hill views. The bonus room, the walk-in pantry, the skylight, and the solar tubes are exactly the kind of practical upgrades that move buyers past browsing and toward scheduling a showing. On paper and in person, this home earns its price point.

The listing came off market after 19 days without a sale. For a home with these assets, that outcome points to a strategy gap, not a property problem. At \$959 per square foot, this listing sits at the upper tier of Orinda's pricing range, and buyers shopping at that level are comparative and careful. A description that leads with all-caps neighborhood branding and a feature inventory, rather than the experiential qualities that make this home worth the number, gives those buyers less reason to drive out. The distribution strategy needed to match the price point it was supporting.

\$1,895,000

List Price

\$959/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch for this property needs to do one thing above everything else: build the case for \$959 per square foot visually and narratively, before a buyer ever requests a showing. The view, the lot, the single-level layout, and the quality of the updates are all premium-tier assets. They need premium-tier presentation to justify the number to buyers who are comparing this home against every other updated Orinda listing in the same range.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: A Premium Price Point Without the Visual Proof to Support It

At \$959 per square foot, this home is priced at the middle of Orinda's premium tier range. That number is defensible given the single-level floor plan, the lot size, the views, and the quality of the updates. But buyers operating at this price point are doing careful side-by-side comparisons online before they ever contact an agent. When the visual presentation doesn't immediately convey why this home commands a premium over comparable listings, buyers default to skepticism and move on. The listing never gave them a reason to stop scrolling.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Sky Tour places this home's lot position, setting, and 18,320 square foot footprint in full aerial context, giving buyers the visual evidence they need to understand what the premium is actually buying before they set foot on the property.

Friction #2: The Narrative Led with the Neighborhood, Not the Experience

The listing description opens in all-caps with a neighborhood identifier and then moves straight into a feature inventory. Buyers who are comparing four or five Orinda properties in an afternoon respond to descriptions that put them inside the home, not ones that read like a checklist. The view, the quality of light through those expansive windows, the warmth of the flagstone hearth, the way the kitchen island functions as the center of the floor plan - none of that was communicated in a way that creates a feeling. At \$1,895,000, buyers need to feel something before they'll drive out.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Zillow Showcase placement pairs premium narrative remarks with enhanced listing pages, so the first thing a buyer reads tells the story of this home's character rather than listing its specifications.

Friction #3: The Right Buyers Were Never Actively Found

A 19-day listing window in today's Orinda market, with no sale and no visible pivot, suggests the distribution strategy was built to wait rather than to reach. The buyers most likely to pay top-of-range pricing for a single-level view home in Orinda are often professionals coming out of San Francisco or Oakland who are researching Lamorinda online well before they're actively touring. Passive MLS syndication puts a home in front of buyers who are already searching. It doesn't find the ones who are still deciding where to search.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork runs geo-targeted digital campaigns into San Francisco and East Bay zip codes where future Orinda buyers are actively researching, reaching decision-makers before they've narrowed their search to any single community.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	136 Ardith Dr.	Orinda Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$959/sqft	Premium tier: \$900–\$1,000/sqft
Lot / Setting	18,320 sqft lot with hill views	Typical updated Orinda lots: 8,000–12,000 sqft
Architectural Character	Single-level open floor plan, 1959 build with extensive updates	Mix of single and two-story; true single-level is less common
Premium Features	10-ft kitchen island, flagstone hearth, wide plank hardwood floors, bonus room, skylight, solar tubes, hill views	Standard updated kitchen and baths; view lots less frequent
HOA	None	Most Orinda residential neighborhoods carry no HOA

The verdict: At \$959/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$900–\$1,000/sqft, this home sits in the middle of that range. At \$959 per square foot, this home sits at the middle of Orinda's premium pricing tier, a position supported by the lot size, single-level layout, hill views, and the quality of the updates. The numbers are defensible. What the listing strategy needed to do was build the case for that number in the marketing itself, so buyers arrived at showings already convinced rather than still comparing. That's the gap a relaunch has to close.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Building the Visual Case for a Premium Lot and View

The 18,320 square foot lot and the hill views at 136 Ardith Dr. are premium assets that simply don't register in standard listing photography. Ground-level shots of the exterior and interior rooms don't communicate lot depth, setting, or the spatial relationship between the home and the landscape around it. A Sky Tour gives buyers the aerial perspective they need to understand what this property actually is before they schedule a showing. Buyers who arrive informed are buyers who are ready to make decisions.

Pillar II - Rewriting the Story This Home Tells Online

The listing description for this home reads like a feature inventory, which is how most listings are written. At \$1,895,000, that's not enough. Buyers at this price point are spending real time with listing remarks before they commit to a drive out to Orinda, and a description that puts them inside the living experience, not just inside the floor plan, makes that drive feel worthwhile. BrightWork's Matterport 3D tour compounds that effect, letting out-of-area buyers walk the single-level floor plan from anywhere, any time, with the kind of spatial clarity that a photo gallery can't replicate.

Pillar III - Reaching the Buyers Who Haven't Found Orinda Yet

The most qualified buyers for a home like this often aren't searching Orinda specifically when they first encounter it. They're researching Lamorinda broadly, coming out of San Francisco or Oakland, looking for something they haven't quite named yet. BrightWork's geo-targeted campaigns put this home in front of those buyers where they're actively researching, not just where they've already decided to look. That's the difference between waiting for the right buyer to find the listing and going out to find them first.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

BrightWork Realty Advocates is a licensed real estate team operated by Ben Olsen, REALTOR, California DRE License #01409268. This communication is not intended to solicit properties currently listed for sale or under active representation.

The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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THE BRIGHTWORK ADVANTAGE

- Buy Before You Sell
- BrightFlip Pre-Sale Improvements
- Final Offer Platform
- Zillow Showcase + homes.com Premium
- Off-Market Network
- Built to Close Clean

YOUR LISTING ADVISOR

Ben Olsen

Founding Partner | REALTOR · BrightWork Realty Advocates · DRE# 02014153

Ben founded BrightWork on a specific premise: the best outcomes are built before a home ever lists. With twenty years serving the East Bay's most competitive submarkets, he's developed a clear point of view on what separates a sale that closes well from one that doesn't, and the preparation, marketing, and negotiation strategy to act on it.

He entered the workforce at 14 in construction, a background that shapes how he thinks about pre-sale decisions, disclosure strategy, and what buyers actually scrutinize at inspection. That's a different lens than most agents carry into a listing consultation.

His approach to marketing is built on the same logic. Every campaign is designed for your home's specific buyer, not the average buyer. Portal strategy, campaign integration, and buyer targeting aren't add-ons at BrightWork. They're the baseline. Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure before the home lists. The preparation is the negotiation.

20+

YEARS SERVING
LAMORINDA

\$1B+

PROPERTIES
SOLD

1,000+

BUYERS &
SELLERS

WHY HE SENT YOU THIS PACKET

When a listing expires, Ben reviews it. Not to pitch you, but because after enough of them, the pattern of what goes wrong becomes clear. If you received this analysis, he looked at your specific property and has a specific point of view about what happened. That's the conversation he's offering. No listing agreement on the table. Just a review. He'll also walk you through programs that turn seller constraints into options, and show you what a transaction designed to get everyone to the closing table feeling good actually looks like.

Why BrightWork Realty Advocates

Rooted in Lamorinda since 1977. BrightWork is built on the premise that the best outcomes start before a home ever lists. An orchestrated campaign designed for your home's buyer, not the average buyer. Programs that turn seller constraints into options. Transactions designed so everyone gets to the closing table feeling good.

That's The Smart Way to Real Estate.

EIGHT REASONS SMART SELLERS CHOOSE BRIGHTWORK

01 Superior Presentation

Professional photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not the luxury package. The baseline.

02 Premium Portal Presence

Zillow Showcase and premium homes.com membership. Higher view counts, better placement, and buyer inquiries that route to your listing team.

03 Integrated Campaigns

Every sign, mailer, and open house connects to a digital system. Curious neighbors become trackable leads.

04 Modern Offer Management

Real-time portal data guides pricing decisions. Final Offer platform for properties with strong multi-offer potential.

05 Financial Tools & Capital Programs

Capital to fund pre-sale improvements with no out-of-pocket cost until close. Plus programs that remove the timing trap entirely.

06 Off-Market Strategy

A private list of serious Bay Area buyers. Test demand quietly or gain early access before properties hit MLS.

07 Advocacy for Unsold Homes

When a home hasn't sold, we don't re-list at a lower price. We conduct a forensic review and relaunch with a rebuilt strategy.

08 Built to Close Clean

Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure to every buyer before the house lists. He structures listings to attract the best first offers from a position no one can argue with. The preparation is the negotiation.

BrightWork has served Lamorinda since 1977. Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

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Not Every Home Needs a Public Launch.

For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or a different kind of timing — BrightWork has a smarter first step.

Most agents know one approach: list on the MLS, hit the portals, hold open houses. That works for many homes. For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or more control over timing, BrightWork offers a structured, documented private path to the right buyer — built on relationships in Lamorinda that go back to 1977.

OFF MARKET SELLING HAS ITS BENEFITS

Your Home, Your Timing, No Pressure

No days-on-market counter. No public record. No nosy neighbors. Your home stays entirely private until you choose otherwise, and if you do go public later, you start fresh, with a clean slate and zero wasted days behind you.

Buyers Who Are Actually Ready

BrightWork maintains a curated list of serious, pre-qualified Bay Area buyers who have asked to be notified about Lamorinda properties. They are not browsing Zillow. Every showing is by appointment, with someone who qualifies and is genuinely interested.

Real Feedback Before You Commit

An off-market phase gives you genuine buyer response before you decide whether to close privately or step into a full MLS campaign. Either way, you move forward with real data and momentum, not day-one guesswork.

BrightWork's network of private buyers and collaborative realtor relationships has served Lamorinda since 1977.

Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Deep relationships in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda.

WHO THE PRIVATE PATH SERVES

The Privacy-First Seller

No public listings, no open houses, and no days-on-market counter visible to buyers and agents, for whatever reason, professional or personal.

The Seller Still Preparing

Test genuine demand while staging or repairs are still underway, without burning days on market before you are ready.

The Strategically Timed Seller

Your next move depends on how this one closes. Control the sequence rather than react to a public countdown clock.

The Seller Testing the Waters

Get real buyer feedback before committing to a full public launch — or decide you do not need one at all.

Your home. Your timeline. Your terms.

Ready to find out whether the private path is the right first step?

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